Large proportion of labourers and skilled persons are underemployed and the scope for increasing their income is limited.

9. **Dependency:** Rural households are largely dependent on social grants and remittances from family members working in urban areas and cities.

10. **Dualism**: Dualism means the co-existence of two exteremely different features like developed and underdeveloped, organised and unorganised, traditional and modern, regulated and unregulated, poor and rich, skilled and unskilled and similar contradicting situations in a region. These characteristics are very common in rural areas.

11. **Inequality:** The distributions of income, wealth and assets are highly skewed among rural people. There are number of historical, social, economic and political reasons behind the existence of inequality. Landlords and landowners dominate the rural activities. Land, livestock and other assets are owned by a few people.

12. **Migration:** Rural people are forced to migrate from villages to urban areas in order to seek gainful employment for their livelihood. This character of the development gives rise to the formation of cities. Enmity and Lack of basic amenities in rural areas also push the people to migrate to urban areas. This is called' double poisoning' by Schumacher, one side villages are empty, on the other side towns are congested. His book '' Small is Beautiful "describes the dangers of the present kind of development.

10.3 Meaning of Rural Development

Rural Development is defined as an overall improvement in the economies and social well being of villagers and the institutional and physical environments in which they live. According to the World Bank, 'Rural Development is a strategy designed to improve the economic and social life of a specific group of people - rural poor'. In short, rural development is a process of improving the rural areas, rural people and rural living.

10.4 Need for Rural Development

Rural development is very urgent in the context of the overall growth and development of Indian economy due to the following reasons.

1. A major share of population lives in rural areas, and their development and contributions are very much supportive for the nation building activities. India cannot be developed by retaining rural as backward.

2. The rural economy supports the urban sectors by way of supplying drinking water, milk, food and raw materials. Hence, the backwardness of the rural sector would be a major impediment to the overall progress of the economy.

3. Improvements in education, health and sanitation in villages can help avoid many urban problems namely, begging, rag picking and road side slumming.

Chapter-10.indd 207 02/01/2023 16:06:40